

Weekly Writing - Week 1

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1. ChatGPT or the Human Struggle.

In class we discussed the potential of a new course structure one where mostly theoretical aspects are taught as students will ChatGPT everything with a click of a finger. Alternatively, we also discussed keeping the structure same where students learn to code by themselves, using tools from Stackoverflow, TA and Google. Initially I was hellbent on the thought that we should keep the course as it is. It would be better to learn how the code runs/ try it out for ourselves because there's only so much you may remember while reading. Working on a project firsthand allows you to make mistakes and learn to spot them again. Another note is the fact that ChatGPT makes mistakes, you need to be able to correct the code or spot the mistake yourself. That might be combative if the theory taught is strong but what about the specifics that ChatGPT won't be able to handle. If you want your visualization in a certain way or need to look at something different then what Chat has offered, then what? The experience of struggling over a code and looking for the right solution builds a background of basics and skills to work on hard projects. Now here's where I diverge, considering the idea that ChatGPT is already widely used and there's no accountability to stop individuals from using the technology. Curating the class to incorporate ChatGPT as the coding source for some topics does seem interesting, What if there was a section on Mistakes by Chat and fix it yourself or Here's the prompt and code I put in example and ask the student to try out something completely different. You could also look into creating a mini semester project comparing AI codes across platforms and asking the student to rank codes and explain why/ which ones work better and how? These are all ways to acknowledge the tech but also keep the class challenging and technical. While I will still strongly advocate for coursework that makes the student struggle, it'd be interesting to add cases to code with AI as well.